

**United States Department of Agriculture
Decision to Restrict Competition under the Simplified Acquisition Threshold
Identification Number: 1166153**

(4) Justification for Restricting Competition and the Basis for that Decision.

- A. Explain the unique qualifications/characteristics of the proposed contractor or product and why no other contractor or product/service can meet the Government's need.

This is a software licenses renewal, which is necessary to ensure continuity of USDA-NEA's ongoing research activities. Without renewal of this license, USDA datasets analyzed previously using this software will have limited utility as access to the Ingenuity Knowledge Base is required for full practicality of the data generated. IPA leverages the Ingenuity Knowledge Base, a repository of expertly curated biological interactions and functional annotations created from millions of individually modeled relationships between proteins, genes, complexes, cells, tissues, drugs, and diseases. These modeled relationships include rich details, links to the original article, and are reviewed for accuracy by Ph.D. scientists. The curated content in the Knowledge Base is structured into an ontology that allows for contextual information, computation by the applications, and synonym resolution to ensure consistency across concepts. These features make the Ingenuity Knowledge Base distinctive and unparalleled by any other database.

This Ingenuity Pathway Analysis (IPA) software is exclusively designed by QIAGEN. Additionally, the Knowledge Base is proprietary to Qiagen's IPA software and is not available through another vendor.

- B. Describe market research conducted and the results or the reason why no market research was conducted.

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Certifications & Approvals

(5) Technical / Requirements Personnel Certification

I certify this requirement meets the Government's minimum need and that the supporting data, which forms a basis for this justification, is complete and accurate.

 Technical POC

(6) Contracting Officer's Certification

I certify that the data supporting the recommended use of other than full and open competition accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief. I hereby approve this justification.

